

Tesla Inc. (TSLA)

Business and technical progress in key markets, and costs of investments, remain in focus; 2Q wrap

TSLA

12m Price Target: **\$360.00**Price: **\$374.01**Downside: **3.7%**

Key takeaways and implications

Tesla's 2Q non-GAAP EPS came in below both consensus estimates and our expectation driven by lower margins. This included from lower gross margins in the Automotive and Energy segments, as well as from higher opex. We think the lower 2Q profits were somewhat surprising to investors after the strong 2Q vehicle delivery report from early July. Specifically, 2Q revenue/gross margins/EBIT/non-GAAP EPS of \$28.2 bn/16.8%/\$398 mn/\$0.33 compared to company-compiled consensus at \$27.6 bn/19.5%/\$1,503 mn/\$0.55 and GS at \$28.5 bn/19.8%/\$1,805 mn/\$0.58.

We think commentary on Tesla's progress and outlook in key markets will likely be more of a focus for investors than the 2Q results, including those that are AI-related (e.g. FSD/robotaxis and Optimus), and in more traditional areas including EVs and energy. There were some signs of progress this quarter. For example: 1) Tesla commented on good commercial traction with FSD, especially in North America where management stated that attach rates are ~55% on new vehicle deliveries; 2) Tesla disclosed that it has had no material crash incidents in ~380K miles with its driverless robotaxis; 3) Tesla exited the quarter with its highest vehicle backlog in several years, and we think the Y L product cycle in western markets and FSD can be positive volume/margin drivers. However, Tesla also described Optimus as being a complex technical challenge with a likely quite flat and long initial ramp on the S-curve. In addition, the scale of Tesla's robotaxi fleet is still small relative to some competitors. Finally, on the cost to fund these investments, the company suggested capex could rise for another two to three years, and that its opex is also likely to increase.

We maintain our Neutral rating on the stock. We continue to believe that Tesla can benefit over time from its opportunities in

■ **NEUTRAL**

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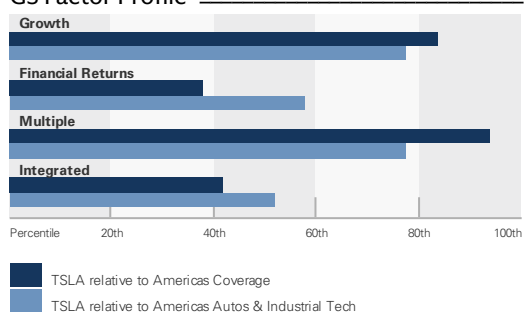
Key Data

Market cap: \$1.3tr
Enterprise value: \$1.3tr
3m ADTV: \$19.4bn
United States
Americas Autos & Industrial Tech
M&A Rank: 3

GS Forecast

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Revenue (\$ mn) New	94,827.0	111,756.6	128,687.5	144,939.1
Revenue (\$ mn) Old	94,827.0	112,367.6	127,030.5	139,995.9
EBITDA (\$ mn)	14,596.0	15,928.2	24,825.2	31,054.2
EBIT (\$ mn)	4,355.0	4,647.4	9,311.3	12,343.2
EPS (\$) New	1.09	1.00	2.00	2.55
EPS (\$) Old	1.09	1.65	2.35	2.75
P/E (X)	NM	NM	NM	146.6
Dividend yield (%)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Net debt/EBITDA (X)	(0.8)	(1.3)	(0.6)	(0.5)
	6/26	9/26E	12/26E	3/27E
EPS (\$)	0.05	0.31	0.43	0.24

GS Factor Profile



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.
See disclosures for details.

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NEUTRAL

Tesla Inc. (TSLA)

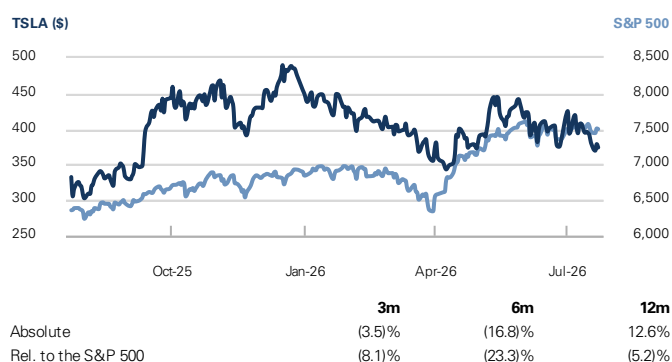
Rating since Jun 25, 2023

Ratios & Valuation

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
P/E (X)	NM	NM	NM	146.6
EV/EBITDA (X)	78.1	80.9	56.4	45.3
EV/sales (X)	12.0	11.5	10.9	9.7
FCF yield (%)	0.5	(0.5)	(0.5)	0.0
EV/DACF (X)	88.9	88.7	62.7	50.2
CROCI (%)	15.9	16.1	21.0	20.6
ROE (%)	5.0	4.4	8.3	9.3
Net debt/EBITDA (X)	(0.8)	(1.3)	(0.6)	(0.5)
Net debt/equity (%)	(13.5)	(23.0)	(13.3)	(12.0)
Interest cover (X)	12.9	12.7	23.3	30.9
Inventory days	57.3	56.2	61.0	60.8
Receivable days	17.3	15.6	15.2	15.1
Days payable outstanding	60.7	64.5	72.2	74.1

Growth & Margins (%)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Total revenue growth	(2.9)	17.9	15.1	12.6
EBITDA growth	(15.6)	10.4	74.2	31.0
EPS growth	(46.5)	(8.0)	99.4	27.5
DPS growth	NM	NM	NM	NM
Gross margin	18.0	19.3	20.9	21.0
EBIT margin	4.6	4.2	7.2	8.5

Price Performance

Source: FactSet. Price as of 22 Jul 2026 close.

Income Statement (\$ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Total revenue	94,827.0	111,756.6	128,687.5	144,939.1
Cost of goods sold	(77,733.0)	(90,220.0)	(101,747.7)	(114,486.6)
SG&A	(6,328.0)	(7,756.3)	(7,869.5)	(8,146.3)
R&D	(6,411.0)	(9,132.9)	(9,759.0)	(9,963.0)
Other operating inc./ (exp.)	-	-	-	-
EBITDA	10,503.0	11,593.2	20,193.9	26,456.0
Depreciation & amortization	(6,148.0)	(6,945.8)	(10,882.6)	(14,112.8)
EBIT	4,355.0	4,647.4	9,311.3	12,343.2
Net interest inc./ (exp.)	1,342.0	1,250.0	1,050.0	1,005.0
Income/(loss) from associates	-	-	-	-
Pre-tax profit	5,346.0	5,281.4	10,361.3	13,348.2
Provision for taxes	(1,439.0)	(1,416.1)	(2,175.9)	(2,803.1)
Minority interest	(61.0)	(62.0)	(70.0)	(88.0)
Preferred dividends	-	-	-	-
Net inc. (pre-exceptionals)	3,846.0	3,803.2	8,115.4	10,457.1
Net inc. (post-exceptionals)	3,794.0	3,803.2	8,115.4	10,457.1
EPS (basic, pre-exception) (\$)	1.19	1.09	2.15	2.75
EPS (diluted, pre-exception) (\$)	1.09	1.00	2.00	2.55
EPS (ex-ESO exp., dil.) (\$)	--	--	--	--
DPS (\$)	-	-	-	-
Div. payout ratio (%)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Wtd avg shares out. (basic) (mn)	3,224.8	3,500.6	3,780.7	3,800.7
Wtd avg shares out. (diluted) (mn)	3,526.3	3,789.9	4,055.7	4,097.6

Balance Sheet (\$ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Cash & cash equivalents	17,950.0	29,265.6	21,912.6	22,340.8
Accounts receivable	4,576.0	4,965.3	5,731.9	6,299.1
Inventory	12,392.0	15,409.6	18,579.3	19,549.1
Other current assets	34,438.0	14,874.0	14,874.0	14,874.0
Total current assets	69,356.0	64,514.5	61,097.7	63,063.1
Net PP&E	46,670.0	66,924.2	86,081.6	102,008.8
Net intangibles	381.0	328.0	288.0	248.0
Total investments	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Other long-term assets	22,113.0	25,777.0	25,777.0	25,777.0
Total assets	137,806.0	156,818.8	172,519.3	190,371.9
Accounts payable	13,371.0	18,491.5	21,741.7	24,762.2
Short-term debt	-	-	-	-
Current lease liabilities	1,640.0	1,418.0	1,418.0	1,418.0
Other current liabilities	16,703.0	18,683.0	18,683.0	18,683.0
Total current liabilities	31,714.0	38,592.5	41,842.7	44,863.2
Long-term debt	6,736.0	7,924.0	7,924.0	7,924.0
Non-current lease liabilities	-	-	-	-
Other long-term liabilities	16,491.0	17,656.0	17,656.0	17,656.0
Total long-term liabilities	23,227.0	25,580.0	25,580.0	25,580.0
Total liabilities	54,941.0	64,172.5	67,422.7	70,443.2
Preferred shares	-	-	-	-
Total common equity	82,137.0	91,985.2	104,435.6	119,267.7
Minority interest	728.0	661.0	661.0	661.0
Total liabilities & equity	137,806.0	156,818.8	172,519.3	190,371.9
BVPS (\$)	23.29	24.27	25.75	29.11

Cash Flow (\$ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Net income	3,855.0	4,606.2	8,115.4	10,457.1
D&A add-back	6,148.0	6,945.8	10,882.6	14,112.8
Minority interest add-back	-	-	-	-
Net (inc)/dec working capital	642.0	2,409.6	(686.1)	1,483.4
Others	4,102.0	4,168.0	4,335.0	4,375.0
Cash flow from operations	14,747.0	18,129.6	22,647.0	30,428.3
Capital expenditures	(8,527.0)	(25,282.0)	(30,000.0)	(30,000.0)
Acquisitions	(6,951.0)	17,338.0	-	-
Divestitures	-	-	-	-
Others	0.0	(7.0)	0.0	-
Cash flow from investing	(15,478.0)	(7,951.0)	(30,000.0)	(30,000.0)
Dividends paid	-	-	-	-
Share issuance/(repurchase)	-	-	-	-
Inc/(dec) in debt	40.0	757.0	-	-
Others	1,684.0	417.0	-	-
Cash flow from financing	1,620.0	1,137.0	0.0	0.0
Total cash flow	889.0	11,315.6	(7,353.0)	428.3
Free cash flow	6,116.0	(7,189.4)	(7,353.0)	428.3
Free cash flow per share (basic) (\$)	1.90	(2.05)	(1.94)	0.11

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.

several large markets, including autonomy, robotics, EVs and energy. However, the trajectory to that better profitability/FCF appears somewhat lower than we had previously expected over the near-to-medium term given headwinds to margins in 2Q and ongoing planned increases in investments in both opex and capex. In addition, while we expect improved growth from these areas to support an attractive long-term EPS CAGR, we also believe the magnitude and pace of that EPS improvement will be somewhat limited by competition (e.g. Tesla is facing several competitors in AVs, EVs, Energy and robotics) and by ongoing R&D/development needs on technology (for example with Optimus). Finally, we see valuation as full.

We lower our EPS estimates for 2026–2028 on lower EBIT margins, and adjust our 12-month price target to \$360 from \$390.

Results

Tesla reported 2Q26 revenue of \$28,236 mn (up 26% qoq and up 26% yoy) which was 1% below GS at \$28,478 mn, 7% above the Street (FactSet) at \$26,423 mn, and 2% above company-compiled consensus at \$27,584 mn.

The total company gross margin (including SBC) was 16.8%, well below GS at 19.8%, company-compiled consensus at 19.5%, and the Street (FactSet) at 19.3%. The 1Q26 margin was 21.1%, and 2Q25 was 17.2%. By segment:

- The automotive gross margin (including SBC, excluding regulatory credits) was 16.3%, well below both GS and the Street at 18.5%. Management cited costs of interest rate incentives (e.g. promotional APRs) and commodity costs as headwinds. The earnings deck cited lower vehicle ASPs (including due to mix) as a yoy headwind. Per the company, the non-GAAP auto gross margin would have been flattish sequentially when backing-out one-time benefits that were realized in 1Q.
- The Energy segment gross margin of 20.4% was impacted by vendor cell related warranty costs of ~\$240 mn, and excluding this the margin would have been ~28% (similar to 1Q26 when excluding ~\$200 in one-time benefits from a tariff refund).
- Services gross margin of 14.1% in 2Q was a record high.

EBIT (including SBC) of ~\$398 mn (1.4% of sales) was well below our forecast of ~\$1,805 mn (6.3% of sales) and company-compiled consensus of \$1,503 mn (5.4% of sales).

Company-reported non-GAAP diluted EPS (excluding SBC and non-cash mark to market adjustments) was \$0.33, \$0.25 below GS at \$0.58, \$0.20 below the Street at \$0.53 and \$0.22 below company-compiled consensus at \$0.55.

Cash, cash equivalents, and investments were down by \$1.2 bn qoq to \$43.5 bn, with FCF of -\$1,092 mn in 2Q.

Product updates and roadmap

On automotive, the company highlighted its strong deliveries as being supported by record deliveries in several emerging markets like South Korea, Australia, Japan, and Colombia. Additionally, Tesla stated that the Semi truck is on track for start of production in 2026.

On FSD, Tesla FSD active subscribers grew to 1.5 mn (up 16% qoq and 56% yoy), and the

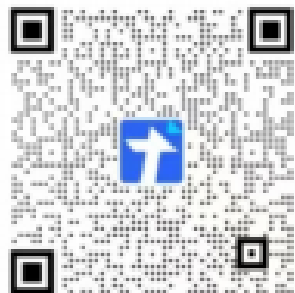
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company began v14 lite rollouts to U.S. and South Korean AI3/HW3 owners. Notably, FSD take-rates in North America were a record 55% in the quarter on new vehicle deliveries. Additionally, robotaxis are now running early versions of v15, which Tesla believes can enhance safety and performance.

On robotaxi, Tesla highlighted the start of production for its Cybercab purpose-built AV in 2Q, and expansions of unsupervised rides to Miami, Tampa, and Orlando in July. The deck indicates cumulative paid robotaxi miles approaching 2.5 mn (up from ~1.6-1.8 mn as of 1Q26). Per management, over 380k of these miles were fully unsupervised across its Texas and Florida operating areas (with the remainder being accounted for by vehicles with some form of supervision). Tesla expects to grow unsupervised robotaxi miles by double digits week on week (albeit off a low base). Going forward, Tesla reiterated its approach to scaling across cities (with limited fleet scaling in each city) and targeting increasingly faster times between city launches. Cybercab deployments will likely be limited, per management, as Cybercab needs to accumulate FSD miles given the new chassis relative to Model 3/Y.

On Optimus, Tesla commented that first-gen production lines are being installed for Optimus, with anticipated production in 2026. Management reiterated that production will follow an S-curve with the initial production being consistently low for a period of time. Tesla expects Optimus units to initially go to its academy for data collection and training, suggesting to us that it could take time before Optimus is deployed for useful work and/or external shipments in a material manner.

On battery efforts, the company noted progress on ramping vehicle pack capacity in Berlin, cathode production and lithium refining in Texas, and LFP cells for its energy storage products in Nevada. Additionally, Megapack 3 and Megablock remain on track for start of production in 2026.

On other efforts, Tesla noted that capacity build-out and ramps for multi-year initiatives in AI compute, solar, battery material, and semiconductor manufacturing are under way.

On financials, management expects opex and capex to grow as it works to scale its AI and energy efforts (e.g. Optimus, Semi, Cybercab, and solar). Tesla reiterated its expectation for capex to be >\$25 bn in 2026. Management also noted they would opportunistically secure debt facility agreements to borrow up to \$30 bn to support their capital deployment plans. Tesla also expects Energy margins to normalize in the low to mid 20% range longer-term, reflecting competition.

We detail results relative to GS and Street (FactSet) expectations on key financial metrics in the tables below.

Exhibit 1: TSLA variance summary

\$ mn, except for EPS and margins

	2Q26				Variance		
	Actual	GS	Street (FactSet)	Company complied consensus	vs. GS	vs. Street	vs. Company complied consensus
Model 3/Y	467,762						
Other models (i.e. S/X/Cybertruck)	12,364						
Vehicle deliveries	480,126						
QoQ	34.1%						
YoY	25.0%						
Energy Deployments (GWh)	13.5						
QoQ	53.4%						
YoY	40.6%						
Active FSD subscriptions (mns)	1.5						
QoQ	15.6%						
YoY	55.8%						
Automotive ex. regulatory credits	20,370.0	20,249.7					
Regulatory credits	146.0	390.0					
Total Automotive	20,516.0	20,639.7		20,048.0	(0.6%)		2.3%
Energy generation & storage	3,139.0	3,829.1		3,773.0	(18.0%)		(16.8%)
Service & other	4,581.0	4,009.1		3,763.0	14.3%		21.7%
Total Revenue	28,236.0	28,477.9	26,423.0	27,584.0	(0.8%)	6.9%	2.4%
QoQ	26.1%	27.2%	18.0%	23.2%			
YoY	25.5%	26.6%	17.5%	22.6%			
Automotive gross profit (inc. SBC, ex. reg. credits)	3,317.0	3,746.2			(11.5%)		
% of sales	16.3%	18.5%	18.5%		-222 bps	-222 bps	
Total gross profit	4,751.0	5,649.3	5,089.0	5,378.0	(15.9%)	(6.6%)	(11.7%)
% margin	16.8%	19.8%	19.3%	19.5%	-301 bps	-243 bps	-267 bps
Operating income (GAAP, inc. SBC)	398.0	1,804.8	1,690.0	1,503.0	(77.9%)	(76.4%)	(73.5%)
% margin	1.4%	6.3%	6.4%	5.4%	-493 bps	-499 bps	-404 bps
EPS (Non-GAAP, inc. SBC)	\$0.05	\$0.39			(\$0.34)		
EPS (Non-GAAP, ex. SBC)	\$0.33	\$0.58	\$0.53	\$0.55	(\$0.25)	(\$0.20)	(\$0.22)

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, FactSet

Updated estimates, valuation, and key risks

We lower our 2026/27/28 EPS estimates including SBC to \$1.00/\$2.00/\$2.55 from \$1.65/\$2.35/\$2.75 prior, driven by lower EBIT margins. Our EPS estimates excluding SBC are now \$1.90/\$2.80/\$3.35 for 2026/27/28 respectively.

We remain Neutral rated on the stock. We lower our 12-month price target to \$360 from \$390 based on 150X (unchanged) applied to our updated Q5-Q8E EPS estimate including SBC. Using a similar framework to our past analysis, an upside scenario could be ~\$500 (based on the 150X multiple applied to 2028E EPS ex SBC estimate), and a downside scenario could be ~\$150 (based on a downside multiple of 60X our 2028E EPS inc. SBC estimate). We have an illustrative DCF scenario analysis by segment available for clients upon request.

Key downside risks to our view relate to potentially larger vehicle price reductions than we expect, increased competition in EVs, a larger than expected tariff impact or negative effects from government policy changes more generally, slower EV demand, delays with products/capabilities such as FSD/4680, key person risk, the internal control environment, margins, and operational risks associated with Tesla's high degree of vertical integration. Upside risks include faster EV adoption and/or share gain by Tesla, a stronger macroeconomic environment for new vehicle sales more generally, earlier new product launches than we expect, an earlier/larger impact from AI-enabled products

(e.g., FSD, Optimus and robotaxis), and a smaller than expected tariff impact than we currently anticipate.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

We, Mark Delaney, CFA, Will Bryant, Aman Gupta and Ayush Ghose, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect our personal views about the subject company or companies and its or their securities. We also certify that no part of our compensation was, is or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed in this report.

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Growth is based on a stock's forward-looking sales growth, EBITDA growth and EPS growth (for financial stocks, only EPS and sales growth), with a higher percentile indicating a higher growth company. **Financial Returns** is based on a stock's forward-looking ROE, ROCE and CROCI (for financial stocks, only ROE), with a higher percentile indicating a company with higher financial returns. **Multiple** is based on a stock's forward-looking P/E, P/B, price/dividend (P/D), EV/EBITDA, EV/FCF and EV/Debt Adjusted Cash Flow (DACF) (for financial stocks, only P/E, P/B and P/D), with a higher percentile indicating a stock trading at a higher multiple. The **Integrated** percentile is calculated as the average of the Growth percentile, Financial Returns percentile and (100% - Multiple percentile).

Financial Returns and Multiple use the Goldman Sachs analyst forecasts at the fiscal year-end at least three quarters in the future. Growth uses inputs for the fiscal year at least seven quarters in the future compared with the year at least three quarters in the future (on a per-share basis for all metrics).

For a more detailed description of how we calculate the GS Factor Profile, please contact your GS representative.

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Quantum

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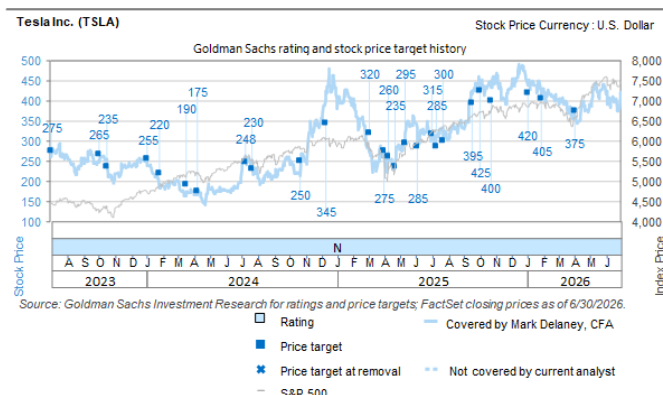
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	Buy	Hold	Sell		Buy	Hold	Sell
Global	50%	34%	16%		65%	59%	43%

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Price target and rating history chart(s)



The price targets shown should be considered in the context of all prior published Goldman Sachs research, which may or may not have included price targets, as well as developments relating to the company, its industry and financial markets.

Target price history table(s)

Tesla Inc. (TSLA)

Date of report **Target price (\$)** **Closing price (\$)**

02-Jul-26	390.00	393.45
02-Apr-26	375.00	360.59
29-Jan-26	405.00	416.56
02-Jan-26	420.00	438.07
23-Oct-25	400.00	448.98
03-Oct-25	425.00	429.83
17-Sep-25	395.00	425.86
24-Jul-25	300.00	305.30
11-Jul-25	285.00	313.51
03-Jul-25	315.00	315.35
06-Jun-25	285.00	295.14
12-May-25	295.00	318.38
23-Apr-25	235.00	250.74
10-Apr-25	260.00	252.40
03-Apr-25	275.00	267.28
05-Mar-25	320.00	279.10
10-Dec-24	345.00	400.99
24-Oct-24	250.00	260.48
24-Jul-24	230.00	215.99
10-Jul-24	248.00	263.26
09-Apr-24	175.00	176.88
18-Mar-24	190.00	173.80
25-Jan-24	220.00	182.63
03-Jan-24	255.00	238.45
19-Oct-23	235.00	220.11
02-Oct-23	265.00	251.60

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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